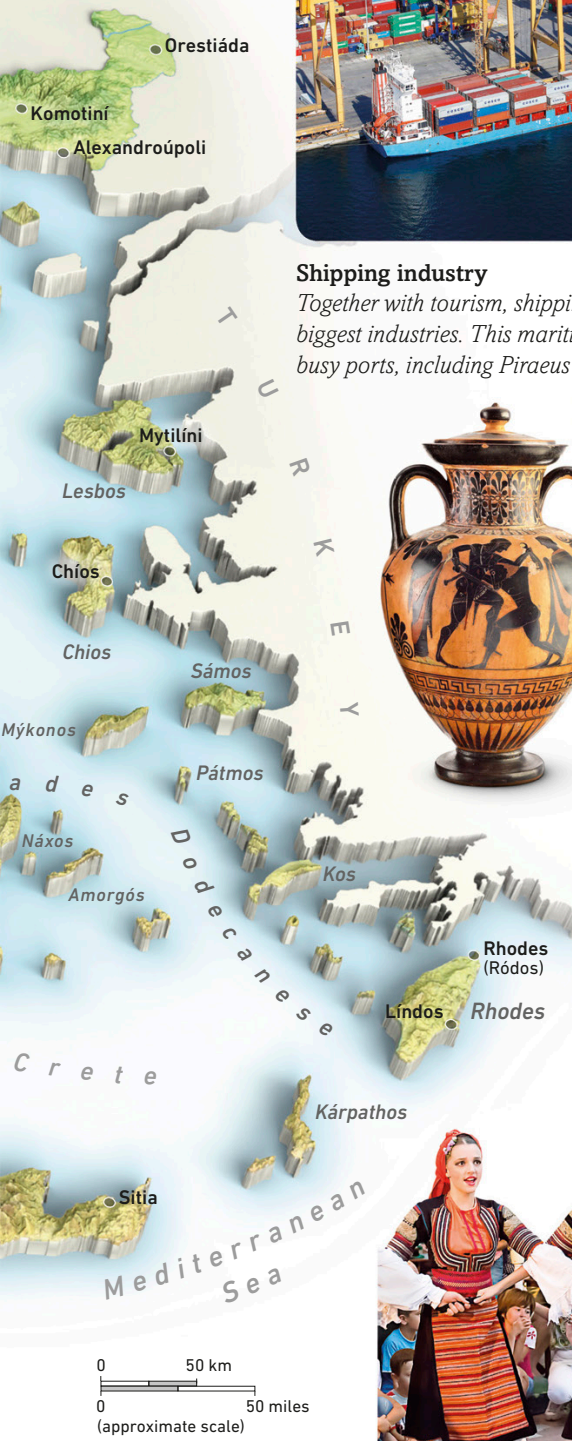




Shipping industry

Together with tourism, shipping is one of Greece's biggest industries. This maritime nation has many busy ports, including Piraeus (above).



Greek pottery

For thousands of years, skilled Greek artisans have handcrafted pots. Many are decorated with scenes from Greek myths. This jar shows the Greek hero Theseus slaying the Minotaur.



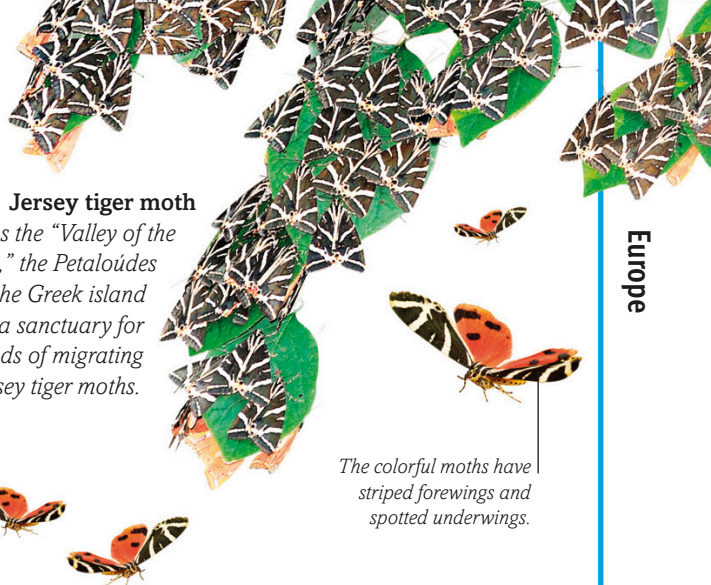
Greek salad

A simple salad of tomatoes, cucumbers, onion, olives, feta cheese, and olive oil is eaten throughout the country.



Folk festivals

Greece has a busy calendar of national celebrations and local village festivals, such as this annual folk festival in the village of Pefkohori. Traditional music and dance, as well as outdoor feasts, accompany these special occasions.



Jersey tiger moth

Known as the "Valley of the Butterflies," the Petalouides Valley on the Greek island of Rhodes is a sanctuary for thousands of migrating Jersey tiger moths.

The colorful moths have striped forewings and spotted underwings.



Santorini island

Many island groups dot the seas around Greece. The volcanic island of Santorini, in the Aegean Sea, is famous for its whitewashed buildings.



Geography: Greece has a **rugged landscape**. Of its **6,000 islands**, only around **227** are **inhabited**.



History: **More than 2,500 years ago**, the ancient Greeks led the way in **politics**, **philosophy**, and **science**.



Culture: **Ancient Greek-inspired architecture** can be seen worldwide. An example is the use of **Greek columns** on buildings.



Natural wonders: Greece's amazing **landscape** includes **Meteora's rock formations** and the **Samaria Gorge** on **Crete**.



Wildlife: The country's **terrain** is home to **bears**, **goats**, **lynx**, **wolves**, and **deer**.



Food and drink: Greeks enjoy a healthy Mediterranean diet of **grilled meat** and **fish**, **fresh fruit** and **vegetables**, **cheese**, and **olive oil**.